NICKOLAS A. FRANKLIN

Leander, TX | nfranklin@franklin-llc.com | 301-741-0843 | linkedin.com/in/nickolasfranklin/

SENIOR TECHNICAL PROGRAM MANAGER | U.S. AIR FORCE VETERAN

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Technical Program Manager and U.S. Air Force Veteran with 15+ years of experience serving as the connective tissue between engineering execution, product strategy, and enterprise delivery across commercial SaaS and mission-critical environments. Proven expert in establishing enterprise PMO governance, driving product strategy alignment, and bridging the gap between Product, Engineering, and operations teams to own scope, capacity planning, risk mitigation, and change control. Combines expeditionary military leadership with postgraduate study in AI Agents to drive end-to-end software programs from initial discovery through final deployment.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- • **Program Leadership & Product Strategy:** End-to-End (E2E) Product Lifecycle, Scope & Capacity Planning, Release Readiness, Cross-Functional Alignment, Requirements Elicitation.
- • **Enterprise PMO & Governance:** Risk Mitigation, Change Control Architecture, Cross-Team Dependency Tracking, Executive Steering, Value Realization & Post-Program Reviews.
- • **Agile Coaching & Execution Workflows:** Scrum/SAFe Mastery, Sprint Planning & Retrospectives, Blocker Resolution, Azure DevOps/Jira Dashboards, Process Optimization.
- • **AI & Agentic Ecosystems:** Multi-Agent Architectures (LangGraph), Agentic RAG, ReAct Framework, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Prompt Engineering & AI Security (LlamaGuard).
- • **Platform Engineering & System Design:** Cloud-Native SaaS Delivery (AWS/Azure), Microservices Architecture, Requirement Traceability, COTS/Enterprise Integrations.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS & AI LABS

Air-Gapped Local RAG Pipeline

- Architected a 100% localized, offline Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline to query dense regulatory frameworks (NIST AI RMF) and technical data without external API calls or data leakage.
- *Tech Stack:* Python, Ollama (Llama 3.2), LangChain, ChromaDB, Nomic Embeddings.

Multi-Agent Enterprise Architecture (In Progress — UT Austin)

- Designing autonomous multi-agent systems utilizing the ReAct framework and Model Context Protocol (MCP) to automate multi-step business logic.
- Establishing AI evaluation metrics, human-in-the-loop controls, and secure decision logging in LangSmith for enterprise applications.
- Tech Stack: LangGraph, LangSmith, OpenAI APIs, Gemini, Hugging Face, Streamlit, LlamaGuard.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Nakupuna Companies | United States Army | Arlington, VA
Solutions Engineer | *Jan 2024 – Aug 2026*

- **Delivery Governance & GTM Readiness:** Managed technical intake pipelines and program governance across enterprise portfolios. Served as Key Personnel driving multi-team cloud modernization efforts (Oracle Cloud Infrastructure) and cross-functional release readiness.
- **Engineering Execution & Dependency Tracking:** Directed quarterly engineering roadmaps and delivery cycles from discovery through release for 20+ distributed development teams, owning dependency tracking, risk mitigation, impediment resolution, and cross-system alignment.
- **Executive Reporting & Data Architecture:** Built program-wide data capture strategies using Azure DevOps and Power BI for executive reporting, improving integrated delivery schedules by 30% and reducing post-release defects by 15%.
- **PMO Governance & Value Realization:** Established enterprise change control standards and capacity planning frameworks, ensuring technical delivery tracked directly to intended business outcomes, ROI, and post-launch value realization.

DLH Corporation | Defense Health Agency | Falls Church, VA
Digital Transformation Lead | *Apr 2017 – Jan 2024*

- **Large-Scale Program Management:** Accelerated the multi-billion-dollar MHS Genesis deployment by replacing heavy DoD governance with lean execution playbooks, aligning 60+ distributed product teams to sustain rapid engineering velocity.
- **Coaching & Team Enablement:** Coached engineering leads and product managers on Agile methodologies (Scrum/SAFe), establishing standardized sprint planning, backlog refinement, and retrospective cadences.
- **Playbook Creation:** Won a FedHealthIT Innovation Award for designing a digital playbook that aligned technical construction methods with the organization's evolving maturity goals.
- **Technical Velocity Optimization:** Used delivery metrics to clear blocked initiatives. Upskilled 100+ developers and analysts, boosting overall software release velocity by 20%.

Franklin Consulting Group, LLC | Independent Contractor | Washington, DC Area
Solutions Delivery Lead | *Feb 2012 – Mar 2017*

- **FINRA (System-of-Record Governance):** Established a Technical Delivery Office for cloud-native applications and built dashboards to track release burn-up, code quality, and backlog health.
- **Capital One (Technical Orchestration):** Managed delivery across distributed engineering teams, clearing API blockers to accelerate legacy monolith-to-microservices migrations.
- **The Carlyle Group (Executive Steering):** Led executive steering and managed vendor cloud (AWS) integrations to proactively escalate risks and deliver actionable recommendations.

EARLY CAREER & FOUNDATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Defense Contractor | Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) | Washington, DC
Technical Project Manager | *Aug 2011 – Feb 2012*

- **Data Architecture:** Delivered an $11M enterprise Knowledge Management COTS solution, establishing integrated master schedules and managing performance metrics for project risk-related events.

Defense Contractor | Defense Threat Reduction Agency (DTRA) | Fort Belvoir, VA
IT Project Manager | *Sep 2010 – Aug 2011*

- **Enterprise Compliance:** Executed DoD 8510/NIST 800-series vulnerability assessments to maintain continuous system authorizations. Authored foundational risk management policies for the OCIO.

AT&T Government Solutions | Army Information Technology Agency | Pentagon & Washington DC
Consultant, Technical Project Manager | *Jun 2007 – Sep 2010*

- **Enterprise Scale Integration:** Delivered a $10M classified VPN deployment and 60+ secure network projects for Joint Forces and the Department of Defense (DoD) with a 100% success rate (zero downtime) in 3 years.

PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC) | Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) | Washington, DC
Senior Consultant | *Sep 2006 – May 2007*

- **Federal IT Governance & Remediation:** Directed federal IT control remediation and business process reengineering for the FBI, reducing FISMA compliance deficiencies by 40%.

United States Air Force (USAF) | Defense Intelligence Agency | Washington, DC & Forward Deployed
Computer & Communications Officer (USAF) | *Jan 2002 – Sep 2006*

- **Expeditionary Systems Delivery & Operations:** Exercised mission command and technical mentorship over 60+ active-duty engineers. Engineered secure, tactical infrastructure for 25K+ warfighters during forward-deployment missions in Afghanistan and Qatar during the initial months of Operation Enduring Freedom.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Postgraduate Program in AI Agents for Business Applications** | UT Austin (In Progress)
- **Master of Science in Leadership (Strategic Management)** | Boston University Metropolitan College
- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Information Systems** | University of Detroit Mercy
- **Certifications:** Scaled Agile Practice Consultant (SPC), Project Management Professional (PMP – inactive)